Checklist

Visa and Permit Readiness Checklist for Candidates

A practical guide to help Indian ICT students, researchers and professionals ask the right questions, prepare the right documents and use the right official sources at every stage of visa application.

AUDIENCE	PUBLISHED	OWNER
Candidate, Student, Researcher	**6 October 2026**	**ICMPD Gateway Editorial Team**

This checklist is a readiness tool. It does not replace the official visa, residence or work-permit checklist of the competent authority in your destination country.

How to use this checklist?

Visa and residence requirements vary by destination country, visa type and your individual circumstances. This checklist is a general guide. Always check the latest requirements with the relevant national authority, embassy/consulate and, where applicable, the authorised visa application centre.

> **The golden rule: go to the official source**
>
> Immigration requirements are not identical across the EU. Use official government, immigration, embassy or consular sources for your destination country, and check that the information applies to employment rather than short-stay travel. A generic EU checklist can help you prepare, but the final document list, procedure and fee are determined by the rules that apply to your specific destination and immigration category.

Before you rely on any information ask

- ☐ Is the same information available on an official government or immigration website?
- ☐ Have I checked the relevant embassy/consulate or visa application centre website for the latest requirements with regards to applicants in India?

- [ ] Is the information current and relevant to my nationality and destination country?
- [ ] If sources conflict, have I followed the instructions of the competent authority processing the application?

Know which visa or residence route you need

What exactly am I applying for?

- [ ] I have identified the EU Member State where I intend to study, work, research or otherwise stay.
- [ ] I know the purpose of my stay, for example, study, research, employment or another permitted activity.
- [ ] I have identified the appropriate visa/mobility or residence permit category that applies to my situation.
- [ ] I have checked whether I need a short-stay visa, long-stay visa and/or residence permit.
- [ ] I have checked the official immigration/visa information for my destination country.

Check where and how to apply

- [ ] I know which official authority or visa application centre handles applications for my destination and visa category.
- [ ] I know whether I need to apply online, in person or through an authorised application centre.
- [ ] I have checked the latest official visa requirements and application procedure for my destination country.
- [ ] I am using the correct and most recent application form.
- [ ] I have checked whether I need to make an appointment, provide biometrics or attend an interview, where applicable.
- [ ] I have checked the expected processing time and application window.
- [ ] I have allowed enough time in case I need additional documents, a new appointment or further processing.

> **EU-level context**
>
> EU countries may share common rules for certain types of mobility, but visa and residence procedures are generally handled at national level. Requirements can therefore differ between EU Member States. Always check the latest information from the official authorities of your destination

> country before applying.

Check your passport and identity documents

- [ ] My passport/travel document is valid for the period required by my destination country and visa type.
- [ ] My passport has the required blank pages.
- [ ] My name, date of birth and other personal details are consistent across my passport and other supporting documents.
- [ ] I have kept clear scans/copies of my current and any previously held passport and relevant previous visas or residence permits.

Have proof of your purpose of travel

- [ ] I have the document that confirms why I am travelling.
- [ ] Depending on the pathway, this could be:
  - **Study:** admission/enrolment letter or other confirmation from the educational institution
  - **Research:** hosting agreement, invitation or research-related documentation
  - **Employment:** employment contract, binding job offer or other required employment authorisation
  - **Other routes:** the relevant invitation, agreement or supporting document
- [ ] I have checked that the dates and other details in this document match my visa application.

Prepare proof of sufficient funds

- [ ] I know how much money I need to demonstrate for my destination and visa type.
- [ ] I have prepared acceptable evidence of my financial resources.
- [ ] This may include, depending on the destination:
  - bank statements
  - scholarship or funding letters
  - employment income
  - educational loans
  - sponsorship/financial support documents
  - other accepted evidence of regular income or savings

- [ ] If someone else is financially supporting me, I have checked what sponsorship evidence is required.
- [ ] I understand that the financial requirement may cover living costs, accommodation and/or return or onward travel, depending on the visa route.

Check health insurance requirements

- [ ] I have checked whether health/travel insurance is required for my visa.
- [ ] My insurance meets the coverage, geographical area and validity period required by my destination.
- [ ] I have the relevant insurance certificate/document ready.

Prepare accommodation information

- [ ] I know where I will stay when I arrive.
- [ ] I have checked whether I need to provide proof of accommodation.
- [ ] Where required, this could include:
  - university accommodation confirmation
  - rental/housing agreement
  - host confirmation
  - other accepted proof of address/accommodation

Prepare your academic/professional documents

- [ ] I have the relevant academic or professional documents for my visa route.
- [ ] These may include:
  - degrees/certificates
  - transcripts
  - professional qualifications
  - language certificates
  - CV/resume
  - proof of professional experience
  - professional registration or recognition, where applicable
- [ ] I have checked whether my qualification or profession needs to be recognised or certified in the destination country.

☐ If I work in a regulated profession, I have checked whether separate professional recognition, licensing or registration is required.

In case of employment specifically

☐ I have a written employment contract or binding job offer where required.

☐ I have verified the employer's identity, address and contact details.

☐ My job title, principal duties and place of work are clear.

☐ My gross salary and any material allowances or benefits are stated.

☐ The proposed start date and duration of employment are clear.

☐ I understand my normal working hours and other key employment conditions.

☐ I have checked whether the salary or job conditions must meet a threshold for my immigration category.

☐ I understand which immigration steps the employer will complete and which remain my responsibility.

Immigration permission and professional recognition are not the same thing

A visa or residence/work permit may allow you to live and work in a country, but a regulated profession can have a separate recognition or licensing process. Check both where relevant.

To understand more about employment related requirements check our EU Blue Card Information Brief.

Check before you proceed

Before proceeding with a job offer or immigration application, make sure that:

- You can independently verify the employer and the vacancy.
- The key terms of employment, including the role, salary and working conditions, are provided in writing.
- Any payment requested from you is legitimate, clearly explained and linked to an authorised process.
- All information and documents submitted as part of your application are accurate and genuine.
- You independently verify any claim made by a recruiter or intermediary about visa or residence-permit approval.

> **Remember:** Only the competent national authority can decide whether a visa or residence/work permit will be issued.

Check translation, certification and legalization requirements

- ☐ I have checked whether any document must be translated and into which language.
- ☐ Where translation is required, I have checked whether the translator must be certified, sworn or otherwise authorised.
- ☐ I have checked whether any of my original or translated documents need to be notarised, apostilled or legalised.
- ☐ I know whether the authority requires originals, certified copies or ordinary copies.
- ☐ My documents are clear, complete and readable.
- ☐ I have checked whether time-sensitive documents, such as police certificates, must have been issued within a specified period.

> **Do not assume every document needs an apostille or notarisation**
>
> Translation and authentication requirements differ. Follow the instructions of the authority processing your application.

Check other documents you may need

- ☐ I have a police clearance or criminal record certificate, if required.
- ☐ I have any required medical documentation or examination results.
- ☐ I have the required civil-status documents, such as a birth or marriage certificate.
- ☐ I have the required documents for any accompanying family members.
- ☐ I have checked whether the competent national authority requires any other documents.

> **Document requirements vary by country and immigration route**
>
> You may not be required to provide every document listed above. Check the application requirements and document list published by the **competent immigration authority, embassy or consulate, or official government portal of your destination country** for the specific immigration route under which you are applying.

> Only arrange translations, certifications, legalisation, apostilles or other supporting documents where they are required for your application.

Check your travel plans

- [ ] I have checked whether I need to provide travel/flight information.
- [ ] I have made sure that my intended travel dates are consistent with my visa and programme dates.
- [ ] I have checked whether proof of onward/return travel is required for my visa type.

Prepare for the application appointment

- [ ] I have booked my appointment.
- [ ] I know which documents I need to take with me.
- [ ] I have prepared originals and copies where required.
- [ ] I am prepared to provide biometrics/fingerprints, where applicable.
- [ ] I am prepared for an interview or additional questions about my travel plans, studies/work, finances and accommodation, if required.
- [ ] I have the required passport-sized photographs ready, following the specified format.
- [ ] I have checked the applicable visa/application fee and accepted payment method.
- [ ] I have kept my application confirmation/receipt, payment receipt and appointment details, where applicable.

Do a final consistency check before submitting

- [ ] I have completed the relevant visa application form carefully and accurately.
- [ ] My name, date of birth, passport number and other personal details in my application match my supporting documents.
- [ ] My study/work/research dates are consistent across my documents.
- [ ] My financial evidence is current and meets the required format.
- [ ] My documents are complete and legible.
- [ ] I have checked the latest official checklist for my specific destination and visa category.
- [ ] I have retained a complete digital copy of my application and supporting documents and have arranged my documents in the order and format requested.

Integrity matters

Never submit false, altered or misleading information or documents. Inaccurate or fraudulent material can affect the application and may have legal consequences.

While you wait

- ☐ I have safely recorded my application or reference number for future use.
- ☐ I know how to check the status of my application through the official channel.
- ☐ I monitor the official communication channels used for my application.
- ☐ I check my email regularly, including my spam or junk folder.
- ☐ I am prepared to respond promptly if the competent authority requests additional information or documents.
- ☐ I know whether and how I need to report any significant change in my circumstances to the relevant authority.
- ☐ Where relevant, I keep my employer, educational institution or host organisation informed about important updates that may affect my application or planned travel.

Do not rely on a generic EU-wide processing time

Processing arrangements differ by country, category and individual case. Use the timeline or status information published by the competent authority for your application.

For students planning to travel to an EU country, explore our Student Checklist for practical guidance on preparing for your journey and settling in.

If you are interested in employment opportunities in the EU, see our EU Blue Card Information Brief for more information on this pathway.